

First contact with the digital natives

If you were born after 1994, you probably don't recall the distinctive sound of an internet connection in progress. The screeching tone of the dial-up modem attempting to connect with a server so you could experience the web in all its glory at 64 bits per second. In fact, it's very likely that you've spent a majority of your life surrounded by mobile phones as opposed to landlines – implying that you lack complete awareness of a period when a phone call was something that required your physical presence in a specific place at a specific time. If you were born after 1994 in India, you are nearly a digital native, but not quite. However, if your first memories of calling home involve using a cell phone and your main resource for school homework was a computer then you're definitely a digital native.

Children born in 2005 and later are normalised to a world that's rife with technology, from tablets to the web. In smaller, nuclear families in the urban setting where the attention of the parents is divided, it's but natural for gadgets to fill the void. Which is why for many families, the use of personalised devices such as tablets has unfortunately become a substitute



Kids are born with internet already set up and running



A toddler playing by himself on a laptop

for an affordable babysitter. As children find constant unending distraction on these devices, they risk being completely removed from experiences that today's adults would remember as being normal from their own childhoods. Take, for instance, the simple youthful memories of interacting with other children regularly in person and participating in physically taxing activities such as games of hide and seek or sports. Today,